

AKHIL & KARTHIKA

Modern & Playful Wedding Website



DESIGN & DEVELOPMENT BLUEPRINT

A frontend-only cinematic wedding invitation inspired by the selected Modern & Playful concept: editorial photography, organic shapes, hand-drawn accents, warm neutrals, maroon/terracotta highlights and polished motion.

Groom	Akhil
Bride	Karthika
Wedding	24 January 2027
Time	11:00 AM - 11:30 AM
Venue	Prince Convention Centre, Alappuzha, Kerala

1. Product Vision

The website should feel like a digital wedding invitation rather than a conventional event website. The selected visual direction is playful, contemporary and romantic, while still retaining enough elegance for a premium wedding experience.

Core design principles

- Modern: clean editorial composition, generous whitespace and contemporary typography.
- Playful: hand-drawn hearts, flowers, organic blobs, taped-photo cues and small handwritten notes.
- Romantic: warm photography, soft light, intimate copy and subtle motion.
- Premium: restrained color usage, refined spacing, high-quality imagery and smooth transitions.
- Personal: the couple’s names, wedding date, location and photography remain the visual focus.
- Responsive-first: mobile is treated as a designed experience, not a shrunk desktop layout.

Reference interpretation

The supplied reference board establishes the visual language: cream/off-white surfaces, maroon and muted terracotta accents, sage/olive supporting tones, organic decorative shapes, editorial image composition and a mixture of serif, sans-serif and handwritten typography.

Primary	Secondary	Accent	Text
Warm Ivory / Cream	Sage / Olive	Maroon / Terracotta / Blush	Deep Brown / Charcoal

2. Website Structure & UX Requirements

The final experience should be a smooth single-page journey with a strong opening moment and clear visual rhythm. The earlier timeline and guest-count concepts are intentionally removed.

#	SECTION	REQUIREMENT
01	Opening / Loading Screen	Full-screen invitation reveal. Couple image, “With the blessings of our families”, AKHIL & KARTHIKA, date and an OPEN INVITATION CTA. Add subtle petals, decorative line art and music control.
02	Hero Section	Large editorial couple photograph with names, date, time, venue and a short invitation line. Use organic decorative shapes and restrained parallax.
03	Countdown	THE COUNTDOWN BEGINS with live Days / Hours / Minutes / Seconds. Thin separators and botanical/doodle accents.
04	Wedding Details	Date, ceremony time, Prince Convention Centre, Alappuzha, Kerala and a View Location CTA. Use a premium card/photo composition.
05	Photo Gallery	Asymmetric editorial/masonry presentation rather than a basic grid. Mix large portraits, small supporting images, overlaps, subtle rotation and image reveal animation.
06	Love Quote	Large typographic pause: “Two hearts, one beautiful beginning.” with generous whitespace and decorative illustration.
07	RSVP	Frontend-only form with Name, attendance selection (Joyfully Accept / Regretfully Decline) and Submit RSVP. No number-of-guests field.
08	Thank You	Cinematic closing image with “THANK YOU FOR BEING PART OF OUR SPECIAL DAY”, couple names and date.

Navigation & interaction

- Sticky/compact navigation after the opening screen, with smooth scroll to sections.
- Floating music control visible without competing with content.
- Buttons use subtle lift/scale/opacity interactions rather than heavy effects.
- Respect reduced-motion preferences for users who disable animation.
- Opening transition should feel like revealing a physical invitation, but remain fast and skippable.

3. Visual Design System

Typography

- Display serif: couple names, major section titles and quote moments.
- Modern sans-serif: dates, venue details, navigation, forms and UI labels.
- Handwritten accent: occasional notes such as “Better Together”, “See you there!” or “Kindly RSVP”.

Imagery direction

Use a consistent pre-wedding editorial photography style. Avoid mixing unrelated stock imagery. Target approximately 10 core photographs, with the option to expand to 12 if the gallery requires more variety.

Recommended photography set

#	PHOTO	USE
1	Hero / opening portrait	Primary visual
2	Romantic close-up	Gallery
3	Candid / laughing	Gallery
4	Walking / together	Gallery
5	Editorial portrait	Gallery
6	Traditional outfit portrait	Gallery
7	Playful / fun couple shot	Gallery
8	Full-body couple portrait	Gallery
9	Kerala scenic / couple environment	Gallery
10	Venue or Kerala sunset	Details / closing

Decorative language

- Use SVG line-art flowers, leaves, hearts and botanical sketches instead of raster assets wherever possible.
- Use organic CSS shapes / clipped blobs for the playful frame around photographs.
- Use subtle paper, tape or sticker-like cues sparingly; the design should remain sophisticated.
- Do not use excessive gradients, cartoon illustrations, neon colors or generic wedding-template ornamentation.

4. Animation & Interaction Specification

Motion is part of the visual identity. It should communicate refinement and playfulness without slowing down the visitor or overwhelming the content.

AREA	MOTION	IMPLEMENTATION
Opening	Fade + mask reveal + subtle petal drift	Framer Motion
Hero	Image scale/parallax + staggered text reveal	Framer Motion / optional GSAP
Countdown	Live number updates + gentle emphasis	React state / Motion
Gallery	Scroll-triggered reveal + slight translate/rotate	Framer Motion
Decor	Floating petals / SVG line-art motion	Framer Motion / CSS
Buttons	Hover lift, scale and soft transition	Framer Motion / CSS
Navigation	Smooth scroll + active section feedback	CSS + JS / Motion
Music	Play/pause state with rotating/minimal indicator	React state + HTML Audio
Closing	Slow image movement + fade-out atmosphere	Framer Motion

Performance requirements

- Lazy-load gallery images and use responsive image sizes.
- Prefer transform/opacity animations to avoid expensive layout reflows.
- Use compressed WebP/AVIF images where browser support and workflow allow.
- Keep the opening animation short and provide an obvious OPEN INVITATION action.
- Respect prefers-reduced-motion and avoid motion that interferes with reading or form completion.

5. Proposed Technical Stack

The project is intentionally frontend-only. The implementation should remain simple enough to maintain while providing the animation quality shown in the concept board.

Layer	Technology	Purpose
Framework	React	Component-based UI and state management
Build tool	Vite	Fast development and production build
Styling	Tailwind CSS	Responsive layout, spacing and design tokens
Animation	Framer Motion	Page reveals, scroll motion, micro-interactions
Advanced motion	GSAP (optional)	Only if complex timeline/parallax effects need it
Icons	Lucide React	Calendar, clock, location, music and UI icons
Typography	Google Fonts / local fallback	Serif + sans + optional handwritten accent
Illustration	SVG + CSS	Flowers, leaves, hearts, organic decorative shapes
Audio	HTML5 Audio	Instrumental background music + visible toggle
Hosting	Static hosting	Cloudflare Pages / Vercel / similar

Suggested React structure

```
src/
├── components/
│   ├── OpeningScreen.jsx
│   ├── Navbar.jsx
│   ├── Hero.jsx
│   ├── Countdown.jsx
│   ├── WeddingDetails.jsx
│   ├── Gallery.jsx
│   ├── QuoteSection.jsx
│   ├── RSVP.jsx
│   ├── ThankYou.jsx
│   ├── MusicControl.jsx
│   └── DecorativeElements.jsx
├── assets/
│   ├── images/
│   ├── icons/
│   └── audio/
├── App.jsx
├── main.jsx
└── index.css
```

6. Functional Requirements & Responsive Behaviour

Functional requirements

- Opening screen must transition into the main invitation when OPEN INVITATION is clicked.
- Countdown must calculate the remaining time dynamically against 24 January 2027.
- View Location should open the configured map/location destination.
- Music control must clearly show playing/paused state and allow manual control.
- RSVP is frontend-only for this phase: validate required fields and show a success state; no database/API is required.
- All major sections should be accessible through navigation and normal page scrolling.

Responsive design targets

DEVICE / AREA	DESIGN INTENT
Desktop	Wide editorial hero, asymmetric gallery, generous whitespace, floating decorative elements.
Tablet	Two-column compositions where useful; gallery reorganizes without losing overlap hierarchy.
Mobile	Single-column storytelling, intentional image crops, compact navigation, stacked RSVP fields and touch-friendly CTAs.
Accessibility	Readable contrast, keyboard focus states, semantic headings/labels, alt text, reduced-motion support.

Out of scope for current version

- Backend, authentication, database or admin dashboard.
- Real RSVP storage, email notifications or guest management.
- Timeline section.
- Number-of-guests field in RSVP.
- Complex CMS/content-management functionality.

7. Suggested Development Plan

Phase 1 — Foundation

Create Vite + React app, Tailwind setup, fonts, color tokens, base responsive layout and reusable components.

Phase 2 — Opening + Hero

Build cinematic opening screen, hero, navigation, music control and transition system.

Phase 3 — Core Content

Implement countdown, wedding details, quote and RSVP UI.

Phase 4 — Gallery

Build asymmetric editorial gallery with responsive image treatment and reveal animations.

Phase 5 — Closing

Implement cinematic thank-you section and final decorative motion.

Phase 6 — Polish

Mobile/tablet refinement, accessibility, image optimization, performance checks and cross-browser testing.

Final design checklist

- Modern & Playful visual direction is consistent across every section.
- No timeline and no number-of-guests field.
- 10 core photographs planned; expandable to 12.
- Decorative graphics are primarily SVG/CSS rather than heavy raster assets.
- Desktop, tablet and mobile layouts are intentionally designed.
- Animations are elegant, subtle and performance-conscious.
- Website remains frontend-only.
- A clear route exists from opening invitation → story → RSVP → thank-you.

DESIGN NORTH STAR

“A playful modern wedding invitation with the polish of an editorial website — personal, cinematic, warm and unmistakably Akhil & Karthika.”